



First-Time Home Buyer's Guide for British Columbians

Your Complete Guide to Buying Your First Home in Canada

Welcome! Buying your first home is an exciting milestone. This guide will help you navigate the process, from understanding your finances to closing the deal. Let's get started on your journey to homeownership!

Assess Your Financial Situation

- Check Your Credit Score: A good credit score can help you get a better mortgage rate (700 + should be the goal)
- Save for a Down Payment: Aim for at least **7.5-20**% of the home's purchase price.
- CalculateYourBudget: Consider all costs, including mortgage payments, property taxes, utilities, and maintenance.

Get Pre-Approved for a Mortgage

- Find a Lender: Shop around for the best rates and terms (Scotiabank, TD, RBC etc)
- Gather Documentation: You'll need proof of income, employment history, and financial assets (your accountant may have it all for you)

Research the Housing Market

- Choose a Location: Consider proximity to work, schools, public transit, and amenities
- Market Trends: Look at recent sales, price trends, and neighborhood statistics (Jump online to get a feel what's available & how long properties last)

Hire a Real Estate Agent

- Benefits: An agent can help you find the right home, negotiate offers, and navigate paperwork
- Choosing an Agent: Look for someone with experience in the areas you're interested in
- Ask them to : send properties in your criteria, keep you updated on sales, send new relevant market information & research anything you are interested in.





Start House Hunting



- Make a wish List: List your must-haves and nice-to-haves (5-10 of both)
- Attend Open Houses: Get a feel for different properties and neighborhoods
- (min once a week if you can)
- Evaluate Each Home: Consider size, layout, condition, and potential for future value





Making an Offer

- Offer Price: Work with your agent to determine a fair offer based on market value
- Conditions: Common conditions include financing, home inspection,Property Disclosure Statement & Strata Documents
- Negotiation: Be prepared to negotiate terms with the seller (price,time frame,deposit)







Home Inspection

- Hire a Professional: A home inspector will identify any potential issues with the property ($400 - $800)
- Review the Report: Decide if any repairs are needed before closing & remove subjects




Closing the Deal

- Final Walk through: Ensure the property is in the agreed condition
- Sign the Papers: Review and sign all necessary documents
- Transfer of Ownership: Once all paperwork is complete with lawyer, you'll receive the keys to your new home!
- Possible Fees to pay : Lawyer, inspection, appraisal,movers & Property Transfer Tax






Moving In

- Plan Your Move: Schedule movers, pack efficiently, and organize utilities
- Home Setup: Change locks, set up your home security, and familiarize yourself with your new home.




Additional Resources

- Government Programs: Explore first-time home buyer programs
- Financial Advisors:Consider consulting a financial advisor for personalized advice






Some things I do for you:

- Arrange showings for homes you would like to see
- Drive you to properties& pick out things you may have not noticed
- Arrange for you tousealawyer,insurance agent or mortgage broker that I recommend
- Set up your own custom Home Search
- Read through important documents such as AGM Minutes, StrataInsurance, Depreciation Report, Surveys, Title Review, Zoning, Disclosure papers.
- Prepare a thorough Contract of purchase and sale
- Identify any red flags in a home

One thing I pride myself on is giving excellent customer service and being with you throughout the whole process so you never feel alone or scared to ask any questions.

Denis Komurcu
5 reviews
★★★★★ 2 weeks ago NEW

Devin is a professional realtor, he helped me succeed in finding my dream home

1

William Chen
3 reviews
★★★★★ a year ago

Devin is my go-to real estate agent. Very professional, knowledgeable, and dedicated to helping me find my dream home.
Highly recommend.

1

Tyson Sheriff
2 reviews
★★★★★ a week ago NEW

Devin had been nothing short of spectacular, in helping me through my first ever purchase!

I can say with absolute certainty, that I will be doing business with him in the future, every chance that I get!

Like

Stephen Lie
3 reviews
★★★★★ 2 weeks ago NEW

Very professional, and honest

1

I am here to assist you every step of the way. Contact us at: 604-809-1032 or devin@axfordrealestate.ca



Axford real estate